Ask for One Clear Change in Your Husband's Care, and Share the Load

Four prompts to pick the one issue that matters most this week, turn what you've noticed into a request someone can act on, find a specific thing to ask each relative for, and write down who agreed to what.

Where you are

Your husband's care is mostly working, but something isn't right, and you've mentioned it twice without anything changing. Your kids ask how they can help and you say 'I've got it,' because explaining would take longer than doing it.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can state one issue as what you saw and what you're asking for, name a specific contribution to ask each relative for, and leave the conversation with the commitments written down instead of remembered.

A one-page conversation sheet with headings: What I noticed, What I'm asking for, What I'm asking each relative to take on, Commitments and dates, and Still unresolved.

Before you start

- The one thing about your husband's care that has been bothering you most, in a sentence.
- A few notes or dates about when you noticed it.
- A list of the relatives who have offered to help, even vaguely. You don't need to have already asked them.

PROMPT 1

Pick one issue and strip it down to what you saw

WHY THIS MATTERS

By the time you raise a concern, it has usually gathered a month of frustration around it. The care team can act on what you saw; they can't act on how tired you are of saying it.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your notes on the one issue, including dates if you have them and how you feel about it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Something about my husband's care has been bothering me and I want to raise it without it turning into a fight. Here is everything I have on it, including what I noticed, when, and how I feel

> about it:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Sort this into three columns: WHAT I SAW OR HEARD, with dates where I gave them; WHAT I THINK IT MEANS; and HOW I FEEL ABOUT IT. Keep my words. If a line blames a person rather than describing an event, put it in the second or third column, not the first. Do not tell me whether the care is adequate or whether anyone did something wrong; I need the sorting, not a verdict.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How short the first column is compared with the other two, because that first column is what you'll lead with.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Add any dates you can find for the first column by checking a calendar or your texts.

PROMPT 2

Turn it into one request someone can say yes to

WHY THIS MATTERS

'Please pay more attention to him' cannot be done by Friday. 'Please check his water glass at each visit and tell me by Friday if that's possible' can.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your 'what I saw' column and the role of the person you need to speak to.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I've observed about one issue in my husband's care, and who I think I need to speak to about it:
>
> [PASTE YOUR 'WHAT I SAW' COLUMN AND THE PERSON'S ROLE]
>
> Help me put this into a request that person can actually act on. Give me a short version I could say in person, under a minute, and a slightly longer version I could send in writing. Each should have: what I noticed and when, what I'm asking to happen, and by when I'd like to hear back. Phrase it as a request, not a complaint. Do not propose changes to his medications or treatment, and do not write anything that assumes the person is at fault.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A request with a clear 'what' and 'by when' that you'd be comfortable reading aloud.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Read the short version out loud once, and if it sounds like an accusation to you, ask for a gentler draft.

PROMPT 3

Give each relative something specific to say yes to

WHY THIS MATTERS

'Let me know if you need anything' is a kind sentence that produces nothing. People say yes to a task with a name, a day, and a size they can picture.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A list of what you do for him in a typical week, and the relatives who have offered.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I do for my husband in a typical week, and the relatives who have said they'd like to help:
>
> [PASTE YOUR LIST OF TASKS AND YOUR LIST OF RELATIVES]
>
> My family offers to help in general, and I say no in general. Help me change that. For each relative, draft one specific ask: the task, how often, and when it would start, matched to what I said about their time and what they're good at. Keep the asks small enough to say yes to. Mark any task that involves his medications or hands-on physical care with a note that it needs to be discussed with his care team before it moves to anyone. Do not rank the relatives or comment on who has done the least.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Asks small enough that nobody has to think about it before agreeing.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Send one ask to one relative today, just one.

PROMPT 4

Write down what everyone agreed, and what is still open

WHY THIS MATTERS

A good conversation evaporates in a week. A sheet with names and dates on it is what turns 'we talked about it' into something that happens, and it keeps the disagreements that didn't settle from quietly disappearing.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your preparation from the earlier prompts and your notes on what people actually said.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I've had the conversations, or some of them. Here is what I prepared and what people actually said:
>
> [PASTE YOUR PREPARATION AND YOUR NOTES FROM THE CONVERSATIONS]
>
> Write a one-page sheet with five headings: WHAT I NOTICED, WHAT I'M ASKING FOR, WHAT I'M ASKING EACH RELATIVE TO TAKE ON, COMMITMENTS AND DATES, and STILL UNRESOLVED. Under the last heading, put every disagreement that didn't settle, and next to each write one question: whether it is something the family can keep talking about, or something to bring to our care consultant or another professional. Leave the question open. Do not decide who is right, and do not write a plan for fixing the disagreement.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Commitments with a name and a date beside them, and an honest list of what didn't settle.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the sheet where you can see it, check the dates as they come up, and bring the unresolved list to your care consultant.

Advocacy starts with a clear picture.

Requests land better when they rest on an organized account of your husband's situation. The care interview builds that account area by area into a Family Care Profile, the file you and your care consultant can both point to when something needs to change.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›